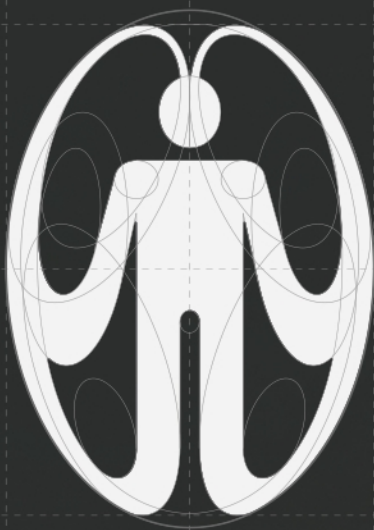




CTRL ONE BASIC OPERATION GUIDE
1ST EDITION
SERIAL No. 10001

HOW TO USE 8 INTERVENTIONS FOR
AN ATTENTION YOU NO LONGER
CONTROL

User manual

NARCISO

ALEATORY SELF-
REFLECTION IN THE
CONSUMPTION LOOP

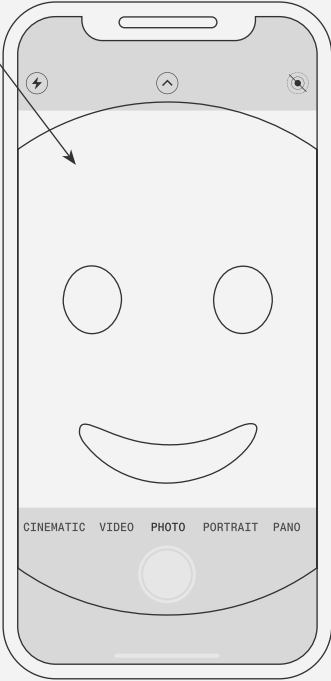
WHAT IT IS

Narciso is a shortcut you can install on your phone that interrupts your scrolling with your own reflection. At random intervals, whilst you're using the apps that take up most of your time, the front-facing camera suddenly pops up: full screen, without warning, without transition. You see yourself staring at the screen.

It's not a notification. It's not a wellness message. It doesn't tell you how long you've been at it or ask you to stop. It just shows you what's there: you, in that moment, with that expression.

The narcissistic cycle disrupted by
genuine narcissism.

FRONT CAMERA



It doesn't tell you to stop.
It shows you where you were.

FIG.20

SCROLL INTERRUPTED



WHY IT WORKS

Scrolling through TikTok or Instagram induces a low-intensity but long-lasting dopaminergic state: the brain anticipates the reward of the next piece of content and releases dopamine continuously. It is the same mechanism that keeps someone glued to a slot machine. You don't choose to stay. You simply don't choose to leave.

That state has one specific characteristic: it suppresses self-awareness. Whilst you're in it, you don't see yourself from the outside. You don't process what you're doing or why. Your attention is drawn forward—to the next video, the next photo—and the observing self disappears.

Narciso introduces exactly what that state eliminates: a mirror. Self-recognition activates prefrontal regions of the brain linked to self-awareness and decision-making—the very same regions that scrolling suppresses. Seeing your own face at that moment is not merely decorative. It is a neurological interruption.

ANATOMY OF THE APP

Narciso is not a standalone app. It consists of two components that work together: a shortcut and a focus mode.

The Narciso shortcut can be installed directly from the iOS Shortcuts app, without going through any app store. It contains the automation that detects when you open a designated app and triggers the front-facing camera in full-screen mode at the most unexpected moment.

The Ctrl One focus mode is a toggle switch. A single tap from the home screen activates or deactivates Narciso entirely: when the mode is on, the shortcut operates; when it is off, the phone functions normally. No need to go into settings, no need to search for anything. One tap turns it on. The same tap turns it off.

No sound. No vibration. No text.
Just the live image of whoever is looking
at the screen.

SETUP

The setup consists of three steps:

- 1 - Importing the shortcuts
- 2 - Creating the automation
- 3 - Setting up Focus Mode.

This only needs to be done once.

PART 1 GET THE SHORTCUTS

Narciso comes in the form of two shortcuts. You can get them via AirDrop, by scanning the QR code, or by downloading them from the Ctrl One website. Once you have them, they are automatically installed in your Shortcuts app.

Narciso Script (grey icon) – this is the shortcut’s programming: the logic that causes the front camera to open at random whilst you’re using the apps of your choice.

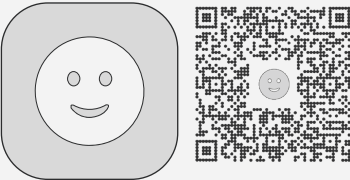
Narciso (pink icon) – this is the switch. The button that appears on your home screen and activates or deactivates the entire system with a single tap.

GREY ICON



NARCISO SCRIPT
SHORTCUT’S
PROGRAMMING

PINK ICON



NARCISO
NARCISO SCRIPT
SWITCH

FIG. 21

FIG. 22

PART 2 CREATE THE AUTOMATION

You’ll need to set this up manually, as only you know which apps are taking up the most of your time without you realising it.

1. Open the Shortcuts app and go to the Automation tab (the clock icon in the middle).



2. Tap + > Personal Automation > App.
3. Tap Select and choose the apps you want to trigger Narciso. Instagram, TikTok and YouTube are the logical starting point, but you can add any app.
4. Tick Opens > Tick Run immediately > Do not tick Notify when run.
5. Tap Next > On the screen that appears titled ‘When [app name] opens’, select the Narciso’s Script shortcut from your library.
6. Save > Automation is now created.

PART 3 CREATE THE CTRL ONE FOCUS MODE

The Narciso shortcut is already set up to search for a focus mode with a specific name. It must be called exactly ‘Ctrl One’ – with the correct upper and lower case letters. If the name doesn’t match, the switch won’t work.

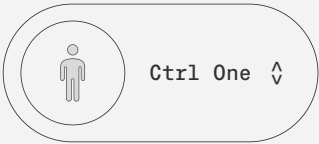


FIG. 23

1. Open Settings > Focus modes.
2. Tap + > New focus mode > Custom.
3. Enter the name: Ctrl One. Choose the icon and colour you want. We recommend the stick figure and grey.
4. Tap Next > Customise focus mode > Don’t touch anything > Leave it as it is and tap Done.
5. Now add the Narciso shortcut (the pink icon) to your home screen: open it from the Shortcuts app, tap the share icon and select Add to Home Screen.

FIG. 24



Tapping the Narciso icon on your home screen activates Ctrl One mode and runs Narciso's Script. Tapping it again turns everything off.

HOW TO USE IT

Once installed, it can be used with a single tap.

STEP 1 ACTIVATE NARCISO

Tap the Narciso icon on your home screen. Focus mode is activated and Narciso starts working. No confirmation, no countdown. It's already on.

CTRL ONE
FOCUS MODE

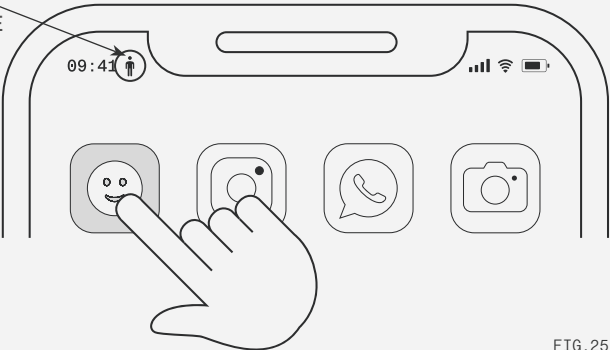


FIG.25

STEP 2 USE YOUR PHONE AS NORMAL

Open the apps you always use, just as you always do. Narciso runs in the background without any visible sign that it's there.

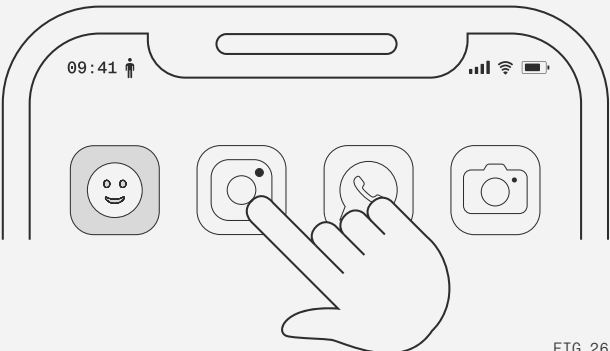


FIG.26



STEP 3 THE CAMERA OPENS

Without warning, the front camera fills the screen. Suddenly, you're looking at yourself—confronting the exact face you make when consuming content unconsciously.

That moment is Narciso. It lasts as long as you decide it should.

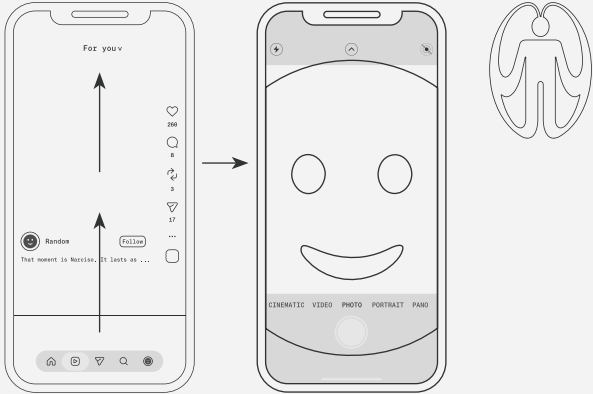


FIG.27

STEP 4 CLOSE THE CAMERA MANUALLY

Narciso doesn't disappear on its own. You have to close it yourself. That gesture – however small – is a conscious decision. You can return to the app you were using. You may choose not to. Narcissus asks nothing of you. It has simply managed to make you present, for a moment.

STEP 5 USE YOUR PHONE AS NORMAL

The same tap turns it off. Just tap the Na icon to deactivate the mode and return your phone to normal.



FIG.28

WHEN TO USE IT

Narciso is designed for moments of passive consumption: aimless scrolling, a session that started with a video and has gone on for forty minutes without you noticing the time passing. It doesn't intervene when you're looking for something specific, when you're sending a message, or when you're using your phone for a specific purpose. It intervenes when you're caught in the loop.

The randomness of the interval is part of the design. If the interruption were predictable, the brain would anticipate it and neutralise it. As you don't know when it's going to happen, you can't prepare to ignore it.

WHAT NARCISO DOESN'T DO

Narciso doesn't stop you from using your phone.

IT DOESN'T
BLOCK YOUR
APPS.

IT DOESN'T
TRACK YOUR
SCREEN
TIME.

IT DOESN'T
GUILT TRIP
YOU.

IT DOESN'T
JUDGE YOU.

Narciso won't save you. He'll interrupt you.

Narciso doesn't send you screenshots or congratulate you when you use your phone less. Nor does it make decisions for you. Once the camera closes, you can return exactly to where you were.

Narciso has no opinion on the matter. Its sole function is to break the state you were in and bring you back, for a moment, to yourself. What you do with that moment is up to you.

CURRENT LIMITATION

Narciso works as a native shortcut on iOS via the Shortcuts app. On Android, an equivalent implementation would require an automation app such as Tasker. In both cases, accessing the camera from a background process is subject



to operating system permissions – permissions that Apple and Google are progressively restricting for privacy reasons.

The main gap lies in detection: native shortcuts cannot continuously monitor in real time which app is active on the screen without significantly draining the battery. A clean implementation would require access to the app usage API, which current operating systems do not freely expose to external developers.

The most effective version of Narciso would require native integration into the operating system. For Apple or Google to implement this is, for now, a conflict of interest.

Face Infinite Scroll

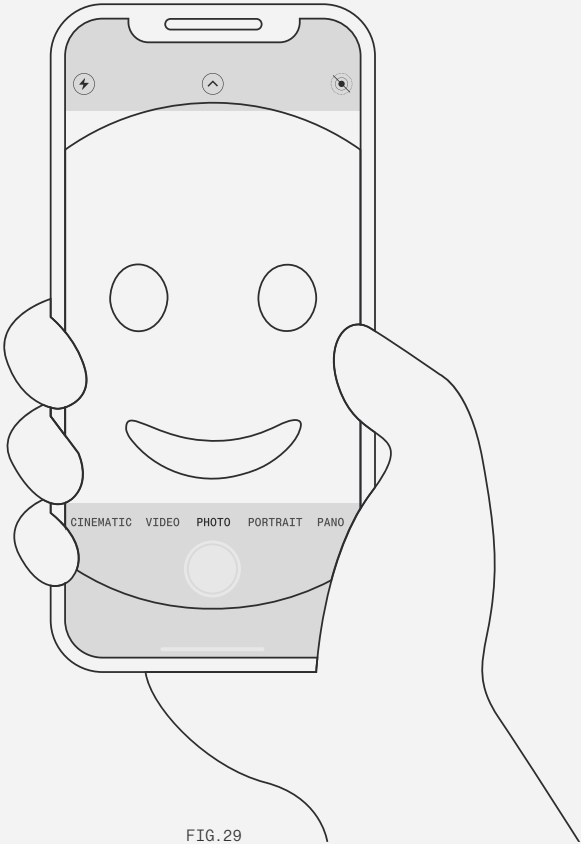


FIG.29